e)Some sources suggest that the reason for the Aūzbegs' retreat was that Babur had received reinforcements from Balkh. While it's true that Bairām Beg had sent a force, it consisted of only 300 men. This small number could not have been alarming by itself, but it might have been seen as a precursor to a larger reinforcement. A more precise timeline of events would reveal whether the Aūzbegs had received news of Najm ṢānI's army advancing through Balkh.

Qarshī and Ghaj-davān

In the meantime, Najm ṢānI, leading around 11,000 men, set out on his mission to confront Babur. When he reached the Khurāsān frontier, he received news of the defeat at Kul-i-malik and Babur's retreat to Ḥiṣār. He gathered additional troops from Harāt and other regions and advanced to Balkh. There, he stayed for 20 days with Bairām Beg, possibly engaged in communications with the Shāh and Babur. Babur is said to have repeatedly requested assistance, which was provided, some sources claim, without the Shāh's permission. A rendezvous was established, and Najm ṢānI marched to TīrmīẔ. After crossing the Amū River, they camped near the Darband-i-ahanīn in Rajab (September–October of AD 1512).

As Babur approached through the Chak-chaq pass, Najm ṢānI extended the courtesy of traveling several miles from his camp to give him an honourable reception. The combined armies then advanced toward Bukhārā, capturing Khuzār and proceeding to Qarshī. Babur initially intended to bypass Qarshī, as he had done on a previous march to Bukhārā, possibly to spare the lives of its people, who had once been his subjects and who were predominantly his fellow Turks. However, Najm ṢānI insisted on taking Qarshī, citing it as 'Ubaidu'l-lāh Khān's stronghold. During its capture, the Aūzbeg garrison was massacred, and against Babur's pleas, all the townspeople, estimated at 15,000 individuals, including infants and the elderly, were killed. Among the victims was Banā'ī, who happened to be in the town. This action provoked intense anger against Najm ṢānI and left Babur not only appalled by the merciless slaughter but also dismayed by the evident lack of regard that his illustrious fellow general held for him.

After the fall of Qarshī, Najm ṢānI's forces advanced toward Bukhārā. As they approached the city, they learned that an Aūzbeg force led by Tīmūr and Abū-sa'īd, presumably from Samarkand, was on the way. Najm ṢānI sent Bairām Beg to engage them, and the Aūzbeg forces withdrew to the north, taking refuge in Ghaj-davān, with the combined armies following them. This